

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q J 3

♥ J 9 5

♦ K 4 3

♣ Q 10 6

♠ A 8 7

♥ K Q 8 7 3

♦ J

♣ A 9 5 4



♠ 10 6 4

♥ A 10 6 4

♦ 6 2

♣ K J 3 2

♠ 9 5 2

♥ 2

♦ A Q 10 9 8 7 5

♣ 8 7

[show S]

You dealt this hand. Decide what you would bid, then click on **BID** above. [BID 3♦]

[show NS]

You estimate you can win 6 ♦ tricks so you open 3♦. Everybody passes.

*West**North**East**South*

3♦

All Pass

3♦ by South

Board 2

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 7
♥ A 6 4 3 2
♦ Q 2
♣ A 9 7 6 5

♠ K Q J 10 8 6 4

♥ 9 7

♦ 6 5

♣ 10 4



♠ A 5 3
♥ Q 10
♦ A 10 8 7 4 3
♣ J 2

♠ 9 2

♥ K J 8 5

♦ K J 9

♣ K Q 8 3

West

North

East

South

3♠

All Pass

3♠ by North

Q J 10 x x x of trumps and nothing in any other suit. Then base your decision on that.

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. Decide what you would bid, then click on **BID** above. [BID pass]

[show NS]

You have 13 points and if partner had opened with a 1♠ bid you'd be feeling "jumpy". But what a preemptive bidder needs from dummy are immediate winners, not points. So you pass.

Here's a pretty good tip: When partner opens with a 3-bid and you are trying to decide whether to take him to game, visualize him holding this very hand: K Q J 10 x x x of trumps and nothing in any other suit. Then base your decision on that.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 4
♥ K 9 5
♦ A Q J 10 4
♣ J 9 4

♠ J 9 8 7 3

♥ A 4 2

♦ 8 2

♣ A K 7



♠ K Q 6 5 2

♥ -

♦ K 6 3

♣ Q 10 8 5 3

♠ A

♥ Q J 10 8 7 6 3

♦ 9 7 5

♣ 6 2

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

[show S]

You dealt this hand. Decide what you would bid, then click on **BID** above. [BID 3♥]

You expect your hand to produce 5 ♥ tricks and the ♠ A. So you open 3♥. Partner responds 4♥. What do you bid? [BID pass]

[show NS]

When you preempted 3♥ you described your hand perfectly. You have nothing more to say except pass.

Board 4

North Deals

None Vul

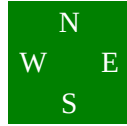
♠ 9 5 4
 ♥ A 9
 ♦ A J 10 7
 ♣ Q J 10 3

♠ 8 3

♥ K Q 10 8 7 4 2

♦ 8 6 2

♣ 5



♠ Q J 10 2

♥ 6

♦ K Q 5 3

♣ K 9 6 2

♠ A K 7 6

♥ J 5 3

♦ 9 4

♣ A 8 7 4

*West**North**East**South*

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North
 happily ever after.

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. Decide what you would bid, then click on **BID** above. [BID 4♥]

[show NS]

No matter how much we try to reduce bridge to rules and guidelines we will never get rid of the judgement factor. With this hand you definitely have 3 fast tricks for partner. In theory he can take 6 of his own, so 3♥ should be the right contract. BUT, maybe he could ruff a ♦ in your dummy?

Fortune favors the bold so you bid 4♥ . . . and live

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 3
 ♥ A K J 4
 ♦ Q J 10 4
 ♣ K 10 5 3

♠ 10 4

♥ Q 8 6

♦ A 9 6 3

♣ J 6 4 2



♠ A 6

♥ 10 7 5 3 2

♦ K 8 7

♣ A Q 9

♠ K Q J 9 8 7 5 2

♥ 9

♦ 5 2

♣ 8 7

West

North

East

South

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by South

lower your preempt, the less difficult it is for the opponent's to enter the bidding. If you had opened 3♠ West might have been able to make a Takeout Double and they could have found their ♥ fit. Just visualize their combined hands; they have 9 ♥s between them, they have no ♠ losers, no ♣ losers and just one ♦ loser. If they decide to finesse your partner for the ♥Q they can make slam.

This is what preempting is all about.

[show S]

You dealt this hand. Decide what you would bid, then click on **BID** above. [BID 4♠]

[show NS]

With 7 estimated winners and an 8-card suit you preempt 4♠. And you are not going to make it. In fact you are only going to make 8 tricks so you will go down 2.

You may be wishing that you had opened just 3♠, rather than following the guidelines and opening at the 4-level. The problem with that thinking is that the

Board 6

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 4 2
 ♥ 10 7 2
 ♦ Q J 5 3
 ♣ K J 3 2

♠ K Q J 9 8 7 3

♥ 6

♦ 9 8 4 2

♣ 7



♠ A 5
 ♥ J 9 4 3
 ♦ 10 7 6
 ♣ Q 10 9 5

♠ 10 6

♥ A K Q 8 5

♦ A K

♣ A 8 6 4

*West**North**East**South*

3 ♠

Pass

6 ♠

All Pass

6 ♠ by North
 would have led a ♣.

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. Decide what you
 would bid, then click on **BID** above. [BID 6 ♠]

[show NS]

If is hard to imagine any hand partner could have
 where the slam wouldn't be there. Maybe you should
 use Blackwood, just to be sure? If partner shows 1
 Ace you would then bid 6 ♠. And if he shows no
 Aces you would then . . . bid 6 ♠ anyway. So you
 leave out the middle step and bid 6 ♠.

Did you think about bidding 6NT instead? Ugh, they

Board 7

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A J 10 4

♥ J

♦ K Q 7 3

♣ A 7 4 2

♠ Q 8 7 6

♥ 5

♦ A J 10 4

♣ J 8 5 3



♠ K 3 2

♥ A 9 4 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ K Q 6

♠ 9 5

♥ K Q 10 8 7 6 3

♦ 8 2

♣ 10 9

*West**North**East**South*

Dbl

Pass

3♠

All Pass

3♠ by East

hand partner will have to do it.

[show S]

You dealt this hand. Decide what you would bid, then click on **BID** above. [BID 3♥]

You make a simple 3♥ opening bid and then the fireworks start. West doubles, your partner passes and East bids 3♠. What do you bid now? [BID pass]

[show NS]

Do not preempt the same hand twice. The idea of a preemptive bid is that you bid it's maximum at your first turn. If there is to any further competing on this

Board 8

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 7

♥ A J 10 7 4

♦ -

♣ K Q 10 9 4 2

♠ 4

♥ 6 5 2

♦ K Q J 10 8 7 3

♣ 8 5



♠ A K Q J 9 5

♥ Q 9 3

♦ 5 2

♣ J 6

♠ 8 6 3 2

♥ K 8

♦ A 9 6 4

♣ A 7 3

West

North

East

South

3♦

3♠

4♦

All Pass

4♦ by North

judgement would be called for, based on Vulnerability, whether you think they can make the game, etc. The Law of Total Tricks can be a help in these competitive situations; it would lead you to 5♦.

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. Decide what you would bid, then click on **BID** above. [BID 4♦]

[show NS]

You do not have the 4 fast winners you need to raise partner to the 4-level. But you do have 4 of his trumps and 2 and a half winners. And your side doesn't have much defense against a 3♠ contract. You should raise partner to 4♦ because you think they can make 3♠. With these hands it appears they might have gone to 4♠ in which case you would have had to decide whether to continue to 5♦. More

Board 9

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 7 6 2
♥ A Q 9 3 2
♦ K 5
♣ A 8

♠ A 8

♥ 8 7 4

♦ J 9 4 2

♣ K 6 3 2



♠ K Q 10 4 3

♥ K J 10 5

♦ -

♣ Q J 7 4

♠ 9 5

♥ 6

♦ A Q 10 8 7 6 3

♣ 10 9 5

[\[show S\]](#)

You dealt this hand. Decide what you would bid, then click on **BID** above. [BID 3♦]

You open 3♦. West doubles, partner raises to 4♦, and East bids 4♥. What do you say? [BID pass]

[\[show NS\]](#)*West**North**East**South*

Dbl

4♦

4♥

3♦

All Pass

4♥ by East

It is partner's decision, not yours, whether to continue to 5♦ as a sacrifice.

You just pass. Partner's raise was probably just advancing your preempt and they got to 4♥ anyway. Sometimes preempts don't do the full job.

Board 10

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 7 2
♥ 6 2
♦ A K Q J
♣ 9 7 5 2

♠ 8 5 3

♥ A Q J 9 8 4 3

♦ 10 7 6

♣ -



♠ A K Q 10
♥ K 10 7 5
♦ 9 3
♣ 10 6 4

♠ 9 6 4

♥ -

♦ 8 5 4 2

♣ A K Q J 8 3

West

North

East

South

3♥

All Pass

3♥ by North
a guideline that says:

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. Decide what you would bid, then click on **BID** above. [BID pass]

[show NS]

The guidelines in the summary would have you bid 4♥. After all you very clearly have four quick winners.

But you also have seven quick losers in the other suits, and a trump void to boot.

Somewhere in some of these lessons there should be

Board 11

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 4 2
♥ 9 7 2
♦ A 9 3
♣ A 8 4 3

♠ Q 5

♥ A J 8 3

♦ Q 7 6 5

♣ K Q 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J

♥ K Q 10 5 4

♦ K J 10 2

♣ J 7 6

♠ A K 10 8 7 6 3

♥ 6

♦ 8 4

♣ 10 9 5

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

3 ♠

All Pass

3 ♠ by South

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. Decide what you would bid, then click on **BID** above. [BID 3 ♠]

[show NS]

The fact that East opened doesn't change your hand at all. You had planned on **Opening 3 ♠**, now you make a **Weak Jump Overcall** of 3 ♠. If partner has some "stuff" you might get to a makeable contract, and if he doesn't you may keep the opponents out of a ♥ game.

This time everybody passes.

Board 12

West Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 8 6

♥ A 5

♦ J

♣ K Q J 10 8 2

♠ Q

♥ K J 10 9 6 4 2

♦ 10 8

♣ 7 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 5 4 3

♥ 8 3

♦ K Q 9 7 6 3

♣ 3

♠ A K 7 2

♥ Q 7

♦ A 5 4 2

♣ A 9 5

West

1 ♣

North

3 ♥

East

Pass

South

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

[show S]

The bidding has been as shown. Decide what you would bid, then click on **BID** above. [BID 4 ♥]

[show NS]

You have four quick winners. If partner had opened 3 ♥ you would have bid 4 ♥ in the blink of an eye. His Weak Jump Overcall describes the exact same hand. So blink and bid 4 ♥.